

FRANCE

Key Country Details Table

Detail	Information
Full Name	French Republic (République française)
Short Form	France
Capital	Paris
Region (UN)	Western Europe
Government Type	Semi-Presidential Republic
Head of State	President Emmanuel Macron
Head of Government	Prime Minister Gabriel Attal
Currency	Euro (€)
UN Member Since	24 October 1945 (Founding Member)
MUN Standing	Permanent Member of the UN Security Council (P5); key EU and global power advocating multilateralism, human rights, peacekeeping, and Francophonie cooperation.



Book Recommendations

Title	Author	Why It's Relevant
<i>France and the United Nations: Power and Representation</i>	Susan Milner	Detailed account of France's permanent UNSC membership and global diplomacy.
<i>French Foreign Policy in a Changing World</i>	Frédéric Bozo	Helps understand France's recent policy shifts and international priorities.
<i>The Fifth Republic at Fifty: The President and Foreign Policy</i>	Sylvain Brouard, Andrew Appleton	Explores how French presidents shape foreign policy in global and UN contexts.

<i>France and the International Politics of Nuclear Weapons</i>	Nicolas Badalassi & Frédéric Bozo	Relevant for UNSC and disarmament topics.
<i>La France et l'ONU: Entre idéal et diplomatie</i>	Jean-Marc de La Sablière	Written by a former French UN ambassador, this book gives firsthand insight into UN diplomacy.

France: UNHRC & Human Rights Resources

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
Ministry for Europe and Foreign Affairs – Human Rights Policy	https://www.diplomatie.gouv.fr/en/french-foreign-policy/human-rights/	France's overall approach to defending and promoting human rights globally.
UNHRC – France Participation Profile	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/hrc/about-council	Overview of the Council France engages with as a voting member.
France's UPR 2023 National Report	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/fr-index	France's self-assessment on human rights for UN review.
French National Consultative Commission on Human Rights (CNCDH)	https://www.cncdh.fr/	Independent institution monitoring France's domestic and international obligations.
Amnesty International – France Report	https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/europe-and-central-asia/france/report-france/	Critical reporting on domestic and international rights issues.
Human Rights Watch – France Overview	https://www.hrw.org/europe/central-asia/france	Monitors freedom of expression, policing, migrants, and

		antidiscrimination laws.
ECtHR – France Case Law	<a [\"fra\"]}"="" href="https://hudoc.echr.coe.int/eng#{\" respondent\":="">https://hudoc.echr.coe.int/eng#{\"respondent\": [\"FRA\"]}	Jurisprudence on cases brought against France at the European Court of Human Rights.
Freedom House – France Country Report	https://freedomhouse.org/country/france/freedom-world/2023	Assessment of democratic institutions, freedoms, and rule of law.
OHCHR – France’s Country Page	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/france	Human rights status and recent observations by UN special procedures.

Title	Link	Relevance
Universal Periodic Review – France	OHCHR UPR France	Core UPR documents: reports, recommendations, state responses
OHCHR France Country Page	OHCHR France	Hub for treaty body reports, special procedures, and UPR
UNHCR France – Refugee Rights	UNHCR France	Information on asylum procedures, rights, and obligations
UNHCR France – Help Site	UNHCR Help France	Guidance for refugees and asylum-seekers in France
UNHCR France – Rights and Obligations	UNHCR Rights France	Details on rights and obligations for asylum seekers and refugees
UNHCR France – Resettlement Country Chapter	UNHCR Resettlement France	Information on France's resettlement programs
Human Rights Watch – France 2025 Report	HRW France 2025	Overview of human rights issues in France

Human Rights Watch – France 2024 Report	<u>HRW France 2024</u>	Analysis of human rights developments in France
Amnesty International – France Report	<u>Amnesty France</u>	Assessment of human rights conditions in France
Privacy International – France Surveillance Report	<u>Privacy International France</u>	Analysis of data surveillance practices in France
European Digital Rights – France Biometric Surveillance	<u>EDRi France Surveillance</u>	Report on France's legalization of biometric surveillance
Human Rights Watch – Surveillance Law Critique	<u>HRW Surveillance Law</u>	Critique of France's surveillance legislation
Human Rights Watch – Olympic Surveillance Law	<u>HRW Olympic Surveillance</u>	Concerns over surveillance during the Paris 2024 Olympics
OHCHR – France Press Release on Surveillance	<u>OHCHR Surveillance Press</u>	UN experts' concerns over surveillance and protest rights
Human Rights Watch – Police Brutality Report	<u>HRW Police Brutality</u>	Documentation of police violence and discriminatory practices
Amnesty International – Police Harassment of Aid Workers	<u>Amnesty Aid Workers</u>	Reports on harassment of individuals assisting refugees
OHCHR – France Press Release on Kanak Indigenous Rights	<u>OHCHR Kanak Rights</u>	UN experts' concerns over the rights of Kanak Indigenous peoples
Human Rights Watch – France 2023 Report	<u>HRW France 2023</u>	Overview of human rights issues in France during 2023

Unique Aspects of France's UNHRC Engagement

Historic Human Rights Pioneer

France's 1789 *Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen* laid the foundation for modern human rights. It continues to use this legacy to position itself as a global moral voice on human dignity and freedom.

Uncompromising Anti-Death Penalty Stance

France abolished the death penalty in 1981 and now leads international efforts for its universal abolition, regularly proposing resolutions and building

diplomatic pressure against capital punishment.

Global Leader in LGBTQ+ Rights

France was among the first countries to decriminalize homosexuality and is a loud voice at the UNHRC for protecting LGBTQ+ rights, including sponsoring landmark resolutions against discrimination and violence.

Feminist Foreign Policy

France integrates gender equality into its foreign aid and diplomacy, promoting women's rights, reproductive health, and protection against gender-based violence in all UNHRC forums.

Defender of Press Freedom

With **Reporters Without Borders (RSF)** based in Paris, France champions freedom of expression and safety for journalists. It frequently challenges authoritarian regimes that suppress media.

Critic of Powerful Human Rights Abusers

Unlike many countries that remain silent, France openly criticizes violations in countries like China (Xinjiang), Russia, and Iran, often co-sponsoring UNHRC inquiries and sanctions.

Hub for Human Rights Organizations

France hosts major international NGOs like FIDH, providing a strong civil society presence and facilitating direct influence in global human rights advocacy.

Model of Security vs. Civil Liberties Balance

Post-2015 terrorist attacks, France introduced tough counterterrorism laws, sparking debate on balancing national security with civil liberties — a case often raised at the UNHRC.

Founding Member & Permanent UN Voice

As a founding UN member and a **permanent member of the Security Council**, France uniquely bridges security and human rights issues, giving its positions

extra weight in UNHRC debates.

Diplomind